claim lines would always keep shifting. After the capture of every objective, the Chinese line moved that much more forward. It is partly because of this tactic that the Chinese definition of the Indo-Tibet and Indo-Sinkiang border changed between 1959 and 1960; yet again in September 1962 and once more after the operations in November. In 1965, an altogether different scenario emerged.

The failure lay not in the Forward Policy but in forgetting the famous dictum ‘he who carries the big stick rules the roost’. Given Nehru’s vague idea about asserting Indian rights in Tibet, the pushing forward of posts in the NEFA area by the Assam Rifles through the 1950s was indeed most commendable. Unfortunately, given Nehru’s conflicting views on China, the Government of India did not do enough to build on these posts. B. N. Mullik understood this aspect, and it was at his constant goading that the Forward Policy was finally declared in 1961. Mullik is today branded as a villain in l’affaire 1962, but that is perhaps unfair. True, he believed the Chinese were not likely to get into a full-fledged war and he was proved wrong in the end. However, that was his perception and he was willing to voice it after looking at all the data that was available at the time. The same information was also available to officers at Military Operations and Army HQ. They refused to even apply their minds to the situation, preferring to queue up behind the flamboyant and totally irresponsible General Kaul instead.

Mullik remains an enigma, the only person who along with Nehru had a role to play in the 1962 affair right from the very beginning. In September 1948, he became the deputy director of the Intelligence Bureau with charge of Kashmir, and was elevated to director on 15 July 1950, a position he would hold till 1964. Outside of Mullik’s own book, *My Years with Nehru*, very little information is available on the work done by the covert agencies during this period. However, two things are clear: the United States through its Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) had a presence in the region even in 1950 when there was talk of the Americans and the British flying an Indian brigade into Tibet. Obviously, with Nehru wanting to project a ‘non-aligned’ face to the world, Mullik was the point of contact with the Americans through the 1950s, during which time the CIA kept the Tibetan resistance going in Eastern Tibet. After the Lhasa disturbances and the Dalai Lama’s escape to India in March 1959, declassified CIA files state: ‘The Chinese leaders recognized, or were made aware, shortly after the